

ACWR 106 Academic Writing for Science and Technology—Syllabus for Spring 2025

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Office: SOS119

Office Hours: Tuesday 14.00-16.00 & By appointment

Course Description

ACWR 106 focuses on using science, medicine, and engineering texts to practice organizing and synthesizing ideas, reporting on technical methods and results, and explaining technical and scientific concepts to diverse audiences. Students will select research articles from their respective fields of study to use as sources for assignments, refining the style and methods appropriate for technical discourse. A portion of the course grade is dedicated to collaborative writing and group work. ACWR 106 is mandatory for students in Science, Engineering, Medicine, and Nursing programs. Students from other colleges or schools cannot take this course as an elective.

Course Learning Outcomes

The course aims to guide students through the learning process enabling them to

- engage in the stages of the collaborative research process, choosing a focus, and planning a paper
- produce a variety of writing within the scope of specific genres catering to a particular audience
- identify and extract relevant information from appropriate academic and scientific sources
- discuss and explain a specific position, argument, method, or hypothesis, and
- monitor their learning/metacognitive skills to become autonomous learners.

Mode of Instruction

ACWR 106 will be conducted in person in the classroom indicated on KUSIS. There will be no online classes, and no recordings of the teaching sessions will be available.

Office Hours

Students are encouraged to benefit from office hours to discuss their work and progress. **I will be in my office for in-person consultations on Tuesdays 14.00-16.00.** Additional hours will be announced before major assignment deadlines. No appointments are necessary for in-person visits unless otherwise noted. A limited number of online sessions will also be available by appointment only. Students must arrange online meetings with the instructor at least 48 hours in advance. I will not hold impromptu or last-minute meetings. Please note that Office Hours may change later in the semester. Students are expected to follow the announcements made in class and through email.

Course Materials

All course materials will be available through KU LearnHub. The instructor may also direct students to resources on other platforms.

Assignments and Grading

Please note that extra or substitute assignments are not possible. There are no final and no remedial examinations for this course.

Position Paper (30%)		
Proposal and meeting Review of peer's paper Draft Final paper	Required Required 10% 20%	In this 1000 to 1250-word paper, using process-description the student will identify a problem, evaluate existing solutions, and defend the preferred position using three peer-reviewed academic articles.

		All steps required. Students will not be allowed to submit if any one of the previous steps is missing.
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Literature Review (50%)		
Written proposal and meeting	Required	In this 1800 to 2200-word paper a student group will identify and explain the significance of an important research problem or issue, carefully analyze and evaluate the work done by other researchers, and present their work, identifying emerging trends. All steps required. Students will not be allowed to submit if any one of the previous steps is missing.
Annotated bibliography	15%	
Submission for peer review	Required	
Review of peer group's paper	Required	
Final paper	30%	
Group member evaluation	5%	

Student Engagement/Participation (20%)		
"Course tasks" and involvement	20%	Engagement in the course will be assessed by formative testing of comprehension of course content and through punctuality, participation in class discussions, peer review, and preparedness for class in general.

Late Policy (for major assignments only)

Any work submitted past the due time will be considered "late." There is a 5% penalty for each day or part thereof if an assignment is late. Work submitted five days after the deadline will receive a "0." The instructor is under no obligation to read or provide feedback on work that is late. Required components that are submitted late will incur a penalty on the subsequent graded work. Submitting work late should not be understood as a right. Late submissions are not recommended and may lead to additional complications.

Important: Course tasks must always be submitted on time and are not covered under this late policy: course tasks submitted late will earn no credit.

Drafts

A "draft" is a completed document with proper pagination, formatting, and word count. The draft must have all required components including ID block, title, introduction, main content paragraphs, conclusion, in-text citations, illustrations, references, and any other required element. Submitting incomplete drafts or outlines instead of drafts will negatively impact the final grade.

Expectations for the final are higher than those in the draft. If the student submits an identical paper or if no additional effort is made, the grade may be lower than that of the draft. ***Students will not be allowed to submit an assignment if any previous step is missing.***

Plagiarism, Collusion, and Cheating

Plagiarism is presenting someone else's words or ideas as one's own, without proper citation and credit. Collusion is where unauthorized help has been provided. If it is discovered that any student's assignments include plagiarism or collusion, the student may fail the assignment, fail the course, and/or be referred to the university's disciplinary council, which may result in suspension.

All work prepared for ACWR 106 must be **new writing**. Students may not re-use papers, topics, or assignments proposed or submitted to another course, including an earlier ACWR 106. Submitting work prepared for and/or submitted to another course will also be considered plagiarism.

Large Language Models and AI

Using AI tools (e.g., Google Translate, ChatGPT, Gemini, Microsoft Bing AI, Monica, etc.) at any stage of coursework—idea generation, drafting, writing, or research—constitutes cheating and may result in failed assignments.

Academic integrity requires students to develop their own ideas while properly acknowledging other authors. Therefore, generative AI is strictly prohibited in ACWR courses. Writing is more than just producing text; it cultivates critical thinking, clarity, organization, argumentation, and engagement with diverse perspectives. Relying on AI deprives students of essential practice, weakening cognitive skills and resulting in generic, conventional responses. Submitting AI-generated work also violates the Koç University Student Code of Conduct. While this course focuses on writing, its broader aim is to develop critical thinking—enabling students to engage in meaningful discussions, tackle complex topics, and assess credibility. Dependence on AI hinders intellectual growth and creative contribution.

Attendance

Regular attendance is key to success, and students are expected to be present for all ACWR 106 class sessions as well as any meetings or conferences the instructor may arrange. The instructor will take attendance for every session using Learn Hub's Online Attendance. Students should monitor their attendance on the same tool.

Students may miss a maximum of 5 class sessions without providing a valid excuse. If a student accumulates 6 or more absences without a valid excuse, they will automatically receive a grade of "F" for the semester.

- A **"valid excuse"** is a documented reason for absence, such as a medical report from the KU Health Center or an official excuse from the Dean of Students. See relevant sections.
- An **"unexcused absence"** is one that does not meet the criteria for a valid excuse.

A student who misses classes cannot earn participation points for the work missed during their absence. Furthermore, there are no make-ups for activities or tasks that are worth less than 5 points out of the 100 total course grade.

Punctuality and Lateness

As professionals in training, students are expected to be punctual. A student who is in the classroom during the roll call is "on time." A student who walks in after the roll call will be marked "late." The first three instances of lateness will be marked as "Late." Starting with the fourth time, every additional instance of lateness will be marked as "Absent."

Participation/Student Engagement

Involvement in the course will be evaluated based on participation in class discussions, peer reviews, preparation for class in general, and completion of "course tasks" (classwork or homework). For each piece of incomplete, late, or missed course task, the student will lose points from the 20% total. Students may also lose participation points for not being prepared or not having materials. The instructor will keep track of student engagement. **Please remember that "participation" is not synonymous with "attendance." Students cannot get participation points if they are absent.** A student who misses class sessions cannot earn participation points for the work missed during their absence. Furthermore, there are no make-ups for activities or tasks that are worth less than 5 points out of the 100 total course grade.

Photography, video, and audio recordings

Students are expected to take notes. Taking photos and/or making audio or video recordings during class sessions is not allowed. This includes taking photos of the whiteboard or the projection.

Medical Leaves

In case of a health issue, the student must contact the KU Health Center. If the student is given medical leave, the Health Center will officially notify the instructor. The Health Center must receive medical reports within 7 calendar days of the absence.

- Only the Koç University Health Center can send an official medical report to the instructor.
- Medical reports (including printouts, photographs, photocopies, screenshots, scans, images, etc.) emailed or presented to the instructor directly by the student will not be valid.
- Valid (approved by KU Health Center) medical reports are listed on KUSIS.
- Only the days listed on the medical reports will be marked as “excused” on the Learn Hub Online Attendance tool.
- These rules also apply to medical reports obtained from other hospitals or healthcare facilities. Reports from these institutions must be sent to the Koç University Health Center and not to the instructor.

Absences Connected with Official Excuses

To be officially excused from classes in connection with university-sponsored projects or activities, students must arrange the required documentation with the Office of the Dean of Students.

- Only the Office of the Dean of Students can send official excuses to the instructor.
- Official excuses emailed or presented to the instructor directly by the student will not be valid.
- Valid (approved by the Office of the Dean of Students) excuses are listed on KUSIS.
- Only the days listed on the excuse provided by the Office of the Dean of Students will be marked as “excused” on the Learn Hub Online Attendance tool.
- If the Office of the Dean of Students does not approve the absence, it will not count as “excused.”
- Requests sent to the instructor by departments, or third parties will not make the absence “excused.”
- Paperwork conducted at government offices, visits to law enforcement and judicial authorities, embassies, visa appointments, employment fairs, job interviews, and scheduled (i.e. non-emergency) doctor’s appointments or activity of any kind coinciding with class time will not count as “excused.”

Grade Disputes

The student has the right to petition for the reassessment of course assignments. If the student believes that an assignment has been unfairly or inaccurately graded, they should follow these instructions:

1. Once the grade has been posted, the student should arrange to meet with their instructor as soon as possible to discuss the concerns. **The student must meet with the instructor before submitting any petitions.**
2. During the meeting, the student should ask the instructor to explain how the assignment was graded in terms of Content, Organization, Language/Mechanics, or other grading criteria. The instructor will explain whether the grade was penalized due to late submission, failure to comply with certain instructions, failure to meet the goals for the assignment or any other reason. If the student has difficulty understanding the instructor’s explanation, **they may ask for the explanation in written form.** If the student remains unsatisfied with the instructor’s explanation of the grade, they should proceed to step 3.
3. The student must complete the petition form and email it to the CSSH Dean’s office at Murat Ak in the CSSH Dean’s Office – muak@ku.edu.tr
4. If the dispute concerns multiple assignments, **a separate petition form must be submitted for each assignment.** Students may **NOT** fill out a single petition asking for all course assignments to be reviewed.
5. The assignment grade and the final grade in the course **may go up, down, or remain unchanged** as a result of the reassessment process.

These petitions will only be accepted **within seven days** after the grade has been posted to discuss the grade(s) in question.

Grading Scale

A 90–100	B+ 83–86	C+ 73–76	D+ 64–66	F 0–59
A- 87–89	B 80–82	C 70–72	D 60–63	
	B- 77–79	C- 67–69		

Course Guidelines and Expectations

Students are expected to:

- Read, understand, and comply with all directions, instructions, rules, expectations, guidelines
- Attend all classes
- Participate actively, and be prepared to write and speak
- Have readings, assignments, and all required materials ready
- Not submit plagiarized work or work that has been produced through collusion
- Not submit work that was prepared or submitted to another course or an earlier ACWR 106
- Meet submission deadlines and be aware of course policies and rules
- Behave respectfully toward the instructor and fellow students
- Communicate professionally and politely with the instructor
- Submit neat and professional work to Learn Hub through the Turnitin tool as instructed.

Email

- The instructor will reply to emails in 24 hours, typically sooner
- Messages sent after business hours will be answered the next day
- Messages sent during the weekend will be answered on Monday
- All communications with the instructor must be in correct and proper English
- Writing, classwork, homework, or assignments sent through email will not be accepted and will not count as submitted.

Important: The instructor will present additional guidelines and rules during the first week of classes. These constitute an integral part of this syllabus and will be made available as separate files.

Please note that all syllabus contents, including the Weekly Plan, and any Additional Guidelines provided are subject to change. Please follow in-class announcements and emails.

Spring 2025 Weekly Plan

This is subject to change. Follow instructions and announcements provided in class and/or in emails.

Week	Dates	Course Content	Assessments/Assignments/Activities
1	Feb 17 Feb 19	Introduction to Course and Syllabus Technical writing skills and video	First day of classes Feb 17 Feb 19— CW1: Video-based Activity (1%) Style Manual Assigned
2	Feb 24 Feb 26	Technical writing skills, clear expression, economic writing, vocabulary, etc.	Feb 24— CW2: In-class Diagnostic Writing (2%) Feb 26— CW3: Definition Paragraph Activity (1%) Add-drop Feb 28
3	Mar 03 Mar 05	Preparation for the Position Paper Work on Position Paper	Position Paper assigned Style Manual Assignment due Mar 5 Position Paper Proposal/Discussions
4	Mar 10 Mar 12	Work on Position Paper Library session	Mar 12, Wednesday: Mandatory Library Session @ Basement Floor Classroom (Attendance will be taken)
5	Mar 17 Mar 19	Monday In-class peer review of position papers Wednesday No class (Grading)	Position Paper Draft due Mar 16, Sunday @ 23.59
6	Mar 24 Mar 26	Classes are replaced with optional consultations	[Instructor Standardization]
7	Mar 31 Apr 02	Ramazan Bayramı and Spring Break	
8	Apr 07 Apr 09	Introduction to the Literature Review Set up LR Groups Proposal guidelines	Assign LR Proposal/Work Plan Assign LR Annotated Bibliography Position Paper Final Due April 9 @ 23.59
9	Apr 14 Apr 16	Identifying and analyzing relevant articles	LR Plan Due (Instructor feedback)
10	Apr 21 Apr 23	AB Work	Holiday April 23
11	Apr 28 Apr 30	AB Work	Annotated Bibliography due Holiday May 1
12	May 05 May 07	Grading/Global feedback for AB Organizing the LR	

13	May 12 May 14	LR Draft Work	
14	May 19 May 21	LR Draft for Peer Review Activity (Start in class)	LR Draft due [Instructor: LR Standardization] Holiday May 19
15	May 26 May 28	Group Tutorials replace classes	Last day of classes LR Final and Group Member Evaluations due May 30, Friday @ 5pm